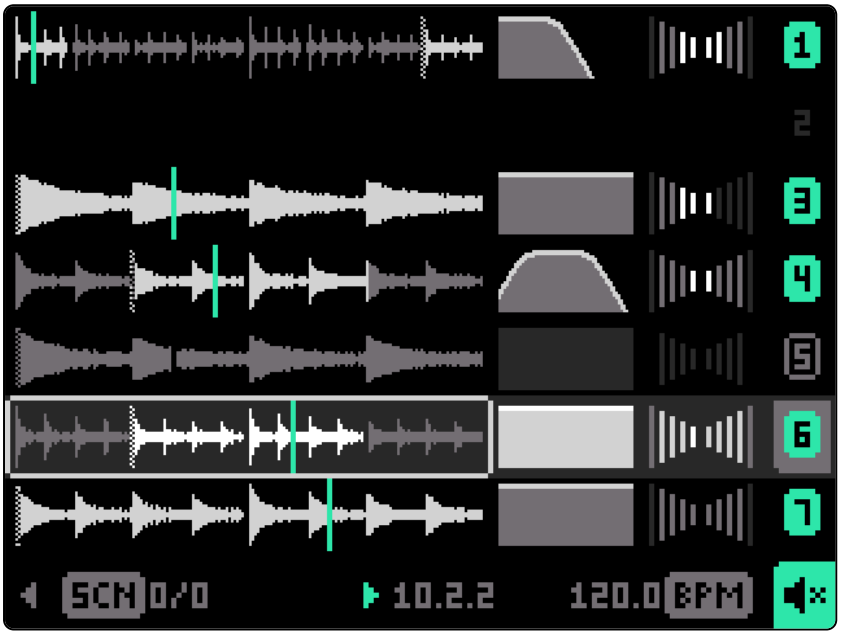
L7

A 7-track looper for the Dirtywave M8. Quick user's guide.

L7 replaces the M8's own firmware with a live looper. You record loops from the M8's line input onto 7 tracks, shape each one (range, filter, volume, balance), and store combinations as **scenes**. You keep up to 12 **projects** on the SD card, and you can export any of them as an Ableton Live set.

The M8's keys are named on the device: the arrows, `SHIFT`, `START`, `B` (OPT), `A` (EDIT) and the power key. This guide uses those names.

The screen



Track rows: tracks 1 (top) to 7. Each row has three cells and a button.

Waveform: the recorded loop; the bright part is the range that plays, the line is the playhead.

Filter: the response of the track's highpass and lowpass filter.

Volume: the track's level and balance, with a level meter.

Button (right): the track number, filled while the track plays, outlined while it's muted, dim while it's empty.

Status row (bottom): the scene (`SCN 3/7`), the clock (bar.beat.step), the tempo, and the **action button**, which always shows what `A` will do.

The selected cell has a light frame. Move it with the arrows. The colour accents follow the loaded project's colour.

Keys at a glance

KEYS	WHAT THEY DO
Arrows	Move the selection: `UP` / `DOWN` between rows, `LEFT` / `RIGHT` between cells.
`A` on a track	Empty track: record, press again to stop. Track with a clip: mute / unmute.
`B` held + arrows	Adjust the selected cell (see below).
`B` twice	Reset the cell: whole loop, filter open, volume at unity and balance centred; on the clock cell, master volume back to 100%; on the tempo cell, the tempo the project's last recording was made at.
`SHIFT` + `A`	Cut the track's clip to the clipboard, or paste it onto an empty track. On a recording track: cancel the recording.
`SHIFT` + `LEFT` / `RIGHT`	Put the previous / next recording on the card on the track (in name order).

SHIFT + UP / DOWN	Next / previous scene.
START	Play from 1.1.1 / stop.
SHIFT + START	Restart from 1.1.1, also while playing.
B + A on an empty track	Resample: record what you hear onto this track.
LEFT / RIGHT past a row's first / last cell, UP on track 1, or DOWN on the status row	Open the menu (projects, export, storage mode), once you let go.
Power key (hold)	Switch off. Everything is saved first.

Recording

1. Plug your source into the M8's line input. The input is always heard.
2. Select an empty track and press A. If the clock is stopped, it starts and recording begins on bar 1. If it's running, recording starts on the next bar line. If you press within about a quarter of a second after a bar line, it starts on that bar line instead.
3. Press A again to stop. Loops are always whole bars. If you stop within a beat after a bar line, the loop ends there; otherwise recording carries on to the end of that bar. The longest loop is 32 bars.
4. The loop starts playing as soon as it's done, with no gap.

Pressing A on another empty track while one records stops the first and queues the next one to start exactly where the first ends. In a new, empty project a metronome click plays until the first loop is complete.

Shaping a track (B held + arrows)

CELL	LEFT / RIGHT	UP / DOWN
Waveform	Move the range's start. Tap twice to move it by its own length.	Make the range longer / shorter (¼ bar up to the whole loop). Tap twice for halves and doubles.
Filter	Move the band	Widen / narrow the band
Volume	Balance	Volume (off, then steps of 7.5 dB)
Scene cell		Next / previous scene
Clock cell	Master volume, one step per press (one volume for all projects)	
Tempo cell	±0.1 BPM	±1 BPM (30–240 BPM)

Changing the tempo re-pitches the loops, like a turntable. The tempo belongs to the project.

The status row with A

- **Scene cell**: go to the next scene when you let go of A (while playing, on the next bar line). SHIFT + A duplicates the scene (the same as SHIFT + B twice).
- **Clock cell**: play / stop.
- **Tempo cell**: tap tempo. The tempo follows your taps, and keeps getting more accurate the longer you keep tapping (pause for over 2 seconds or press another key to start over); every 4th tap after the first restarts from 1.1.1 (on the nearest bar while playing). SHIFT + A sets the metronome: **0** off, **A** auto (only when no unmuted clip is playing) or **1** on; each press changes whether you hear it, and the button shows the setting it goes to next.

Scenes

A scene is a snapshot of all 7 tracks: which clip each plays, its range, mute, filter, volume and balance. Whatever you change updates the current scene as you go; there is no save step.

- SHIFT + UP / DOWN steps through the scenes. While playing, the change happens on the next bar line after you let go of SHIFT; the scene number flashes until then.
- Below the first scene is **0***, an empty scene. Above the last is **N+1***, a copy of the last one. Changing either turns it into a real scene. Tap UP or DOWN twice with SHIFT, holding the second tap, to jump to N+1* or 0*.
- SHIFT + B twice duplicates the scene.
- Cut a scene with SHIFT, then B, then A (in that order). Paste it after the current one with B, then SHIFT, then A. Cutting a scene with no clips removes it but leaves the clipboard as it was.

Resampling

With a clip playing unmuted, select an empty track and press B + A. L7 records everything you hear (tracks and input, but not the master volume) from the next bar line, like a normal recording. When it's saved, it moves to a new scene right after the current one, on the same track, and the clips that were muted come along, still muted. The action button shows a record dot with a plus while resampling is available.

Projects and the menu



Open the menu by pressing any arrow past the edge of the screen (LEFT or RIGHT past a row's ends, UP on track 1, DOWN on the status row): the menu is to the left of the looper (the small left triangle at the bottom left lights up while you hold the key). While the clock runs, the loaded project's card shows a small play icon. The clock keeps running. Go back with RIGHT or LEFT off the edge of the cards or on a list item, UP on the top row of cards, or DOWN on the last list item; the small triangle at the top left lights up in the project's colour while you hold the key. With no project loaded, going back makes a new project in the first empty slot.

Cards A–L: the 12 project slots, A–D on the top row. A filled card is the loaded project, an outlined one has a project, a grey one is empty.

The list: export to Ableton, and storage mode.

ON A CARD	WHAT IT DOES
A or B	Load that project (on an empty slot: start a new one) and go back to the looper. While playing, it comes in on the next bar line. Hold the key for a moment to load it and stay in the menu.

SHIFT + A	Cut the project to the project clipboard, or paste it into an empty slot. Cutting a project with no clips removes it but leaves the clipboard as it was.

START starts and stops the clock in the menu too. Each project keeps its own scenes and tempo; new projects start with the tempo you last set by hand. The master volume is one for all projects. Opening the menu with a project that has no clips at all deletes that project.

Exporting to Ableton Live

Load the project, open the menu and choose **EXPORT ABLETON PROJECT**. The clock stops and L7 writes a Live 11 project to the card, in `/L7/EXPORTS/L7 A001 Project/` (the project's letter, then the next free number). The label then reads **SAVED AS L7 A001**, and the button stays off until you close the menu.

- 7 audio tracks, coloured like the project, each with a highpass and a lowpass Auto Filter and a Utility.
- One scene per L7 scene that has clips, plus an empty one at the end. The current scene's clips are armed to play when the set opens.
- Each clip keeps its loop range, start, mute, volume (as clip gain), balance and filter settings (as clip envelopes).
- The samples are copied into the project, so you can move it anywhere.

Storage mode: the card on your computer

In the menu, choose **ENTER STORAGE MODE**, then connect the M8 to your computer with a USB cable. The SD card mounts as a normal drive. The clock stops, and the screen shows the connection state.

When you're done, eject the drive on the computer, or press any key on the M8. L7 reads the card again and you're back in the menu.

> Always eject or press a key before unplugging. Files you add, rename or delete on the computer are picked up when you leave storage mode.

What's on the card

FOLDER	CONTENTS
`/L7/SAMPLES`	Every recording, as a WAV file named `A30012.wav`: the project letter, the track number (1–7) and a number.
`/L7/PROJECTS`	The projects, `A.L7P` to `L.L7P`. An empty slot has no file.
`/L7/EXPORTS`	The Ableton projects you exported.
`/L7/DATA`	Everything else L7 needs, including about 180 MB of space kept ready for new recordings.

Recordings stay on the card even when no project uses them any more.

Good to know

- L7 saves as you go: tracks, scenes, tempo and the loaded project survive switching off.
- When an action can't run right now (for example paste with an empty clipboard), the action button turns grey and A does nothing.
- The headphone output mutes the speaker automatically.

- MIDI clock and start/stop go out on the M8's MIDI out.

L7 © 2026 Daniel Stanciu.